

SEO & PUBLISHING METADATA

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Affordable Cardiac Bypass Surgery in India: Quality Care for East African Patients

Cardiovascular diseases are rising rapidly across East Africa. Unfortunately, access to advanced cardiothoracic surgeries like **Coronary Artery Bypass Grafting (CABG)**—commonly known as heart bypass surgery—remains limited and expensive in many parts of Kenya, Uganda, Tanzania, and Rwanda.

For this reason, thousands of African patients travel to India every year. India is recognized globally for performing high-volume, highly complex heart surgeries with success rates exceeding **99%**, at a cost that is extremely affordable.

In this guide, we detail how East African patients can access world-class cardiac care in Kochi, India, with the support of **Santos Care**.

Why East African Patients Trust India for Heart Bypass Surgery

1. World-Class Cardiologists & Surgeons

Indian cardiac surgeons are globally respected. Many have trained or practiced at top institutions in the US and UK. JCI-accredited hospitals in South India, such as **Aster Medcity** and **Amrita Hospital** in Kochi, house dedicated cardiac centers equipped with advanced hybrid operating suites and robotic-assisted surgical systems.

2. High Success Rates

Top-tier cardiac centers in India report a success rate of over **99% for CABG procedures** (excluding high-risk cases with multiple comorbidities). High volume breeds excellence: Indian

cardiac centers perform thousands of bypass surgeries annually, giving surgeons unparalleled clinical experience.

3. Immediate Access (No Waiting Lists)

In patients with critical coronary artery blockage, time is of the essence. While public systems or local private hospitals might have lengthy schedules, patients booking through Santos Care can be admitted and operated on within days of their arrival in India.

Cost Comparison: CABG (Heart Bypass Surgery)

The cost of heart surgery is a major deciding factor. The table below compares the total cost of a standard heart bypass surgery (including a 7 to 10-day hospital stay, surgeon fees, ICU costs, and post-op care):

Country	Average CABG Cost (USD)	Cost Savings vs. India
United States	\$120,000 - \$150,000	Save 95%+
United Kingdom (Private)	\$70,000 - \$90,000	Save 90%+
South Africa	\$25,000 - \$35,000	Save 80%
Kenya (Private)	\$10,000 - \$15,000	Save 50%
India (Kochi)	\$5,000 - \$7,000	Base Price

Note: The cost in India includes 2 days in the cardiac ICU, 5 days in a private room, all surgeon fees, nursing charges, and medications during the hospital stay.

Minimal Access Bypass Surgery (MICS CABG)

Traditionally, bypass surgery requires splitting the breastbone (sternotomy). However, Indian hospitals specialize in **Minimally Invasive Coronary Artery Surgery (MICS CABG)**.

- * **How it works:** The surgeon accesses the heart through a small incision between the ribs.
- * **Benefits:** Less pain, minimal blood loss, lower risk of infection, and a significantly faster recovery (discharge in 3-4 days instead of 7-10 days). This is highly beneficial for international travelers who want to return home quickly.

Travel and Visa Guide for East African Patients

Getting from Africa to India for medical treatment is a streamlined process:

1. Medical Visa (Med-Visa) Support:

To travel for treatment, you will need an **Indian Medical Visa**. Santos Care provides you with a formal Visa Invitation Letter from the treating JCI-accredited hospital. You can apply online via the official Indian e-Visa portal.

2. Direct Flights to Kochi:

Kochi International Airport (COK) has excellent connections. Airlines like *Emirates, Qatar Airways, Ethiopian Airlines, and Flydubai* connect Nairobi, Entebbe, Dar es Salaam, and Kigali to Kochi with quick, single-stop layovers.

3. Airport Pick-up & Triage:

A Santos Care representative will meet you at Kochi airport with a wheelchair or medical transport if required. We transfer you directly to the hospital or pre-booked accommodation near the facility.

How Santos Care Supports You

We understand that traveling to a foreign country for major heart surgery can be daunting. We provide end-to-end concierge support:

- * **Pre-Arrival Clinical Review:** Send us your ECG, Echocardiogram, and Coronary Angiogram reports. Our panel cardiologists will provide a free medical opinion and cost estimate.
- * **In-Hospital Support:** A dedicated coordinator will be with you throughout your consultations, admission, surgery, and discharge.
- * **Post-Recovery Monitoring:** We assist in booking post-treatment accommodation for the 7-14 days required before you fly back. We also coordinate with your local cardiologist in East Africa for follow-up care.

Get Your Free Heart Treatment Plan

Get a free medical opinion and transparent pricing from top Indian cardiologists today.

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